Hustle Hive CIC – Safer Recruitment Policy

Item	Detail
Organisation	Hustle Hive CIC, company no. 16691281
Policy lead	Gavin Copland, Director and Designated Safeguarding Lead
Version	2.0
Effective from	October 2026
Next review	September 2027, or sooner when statutory guidance changes

1. Policy statement

Hustle Hive CIC is committed to safeguarding and promoting the welfare of children, young people and adults at risk. We expect everyone who works or volunteers with us to share this commitment.

Safer recruitment helps us deter, identify and reject people who are unsuitable to work with children. No one will start work or volunteering with learners until the checks in this policy have been completed, checked and recorded.

2. Scope and legal framework

This policy applies to everyone who works with our learners: directors, employees, sessional and freelance staff, volunteers, students on placement, and staff from contractors or partner organisations who work with learners.

We follow the Department for Education's statutory guidance *Keeping Children Safe in Education* (current edition), *Working Together to Safeguard Children*, the procedures of the Darlington Safeguarding Partnership, the Safeguarding Vulnerable Groups Act 2006, and the Rehabilitation of Offenders Act 1974 (Exceptions) Order 1975, as amended.

3. Responsibilities

Who	Responsibilities
Directors	Make sure this policy is followed and resourced; at least one Director completes safer recruitment training and sits on every interview panel
Gavin Copland, policy lead and DSL	Oversees all recruitment checks; keeps the Single Central Record; assesses any information disclosed by checks; makes referrals to the DBS or local authority designated officer (LADO) where required
Interview panel	Follow this policy at every stage; record decisions and the reasons for them

4. The recruitment process

Advertising

Every job or volunteer advert includes our commitment to safeguarding, states that the role is subject to an enhanced DBS check with a barred list check, and states that online searches will be carried out on shortlisted candidates. Candidates receive a job description, a person specification that includes safeguarding responsibilities, and a copy of this policy.

Applications

We use an application form, not a CV. It asks for full employment and education history since leaving secondary school, details of two referees (one being the most recent employer), and a self-declaration about criminal records and any information that would make the applicant unsuitable to work with children.

Shortlisting

At least two people shortlist against the person specification. They check every application for gaps in employment, inconsistencies and frequent changes of job, and note anything to explore at interview.

References

We request references for shortlisted candidates before interview where possible. References must come directly from the referee, not the candidate, and we ask specifically about any safeguarding concerns, disciplinary action or allegations. We follow up anything vague or concerning by phone.

Online checks

We carry out online searches on shortlisted candidates, as Keeping Children Safe in Education recommends, to identify any publicly available information that could be relevant to their suitability. Anything found may be discussed with the candidate at interview.

Interviews

Every interview is face to face, either in person or by video call, and has at least two panel members, one of whom has completed safer recruitment training. Every interview includes questions about safeguarding and the candidate's attitude to working with children, and explores any gaps or concerns found earlier. The panel records its questions, the candidate's answers and the reasons for its decision.

5. Pre-appointment checks

Any job offer is conditional on the following checks being completed satisfactorily before the person starts.

Check	What we do
Identity	Check original photo ID and proof of address
Right to work in the UK	Check and copy original documents, or use the Home Office online service
Enhanced DBS with barred list check	Obtain a new check, or check an existing certificate through the DBS Update Service with the person's consent
Prohibition from teaching	Check the Teaching Regulation Agency service for anyone who will carry out teaching work
Section 128 direction	Check for anyone taking a management role, such as a director
References	Two satisfactory references received and verified

Check	What we do
Qualifications	Check original certificates for any qualification the role requires
Mental and physical fitness	Health questionnaire confirming the person is fit for the role
Overseas checks	Further checks for anyone who has lived or worked outside the UK, as Keeping Children Safe in Education requires

In exceptional circumstances, a person may start before their DBS certificate arrives, but only once the barred list check is back, all other checks are complete, a risk assessment has been done, and they are supervised at all times and never left alone with learners.

Information disclosed by checks

If a check reveals a conviction or other concern, Gavin Copland assesses it with another Director, considering its relevance to the role, how serious and recent it is, and the person's explanation. Having a criminal record does not automatically rule someone out unless they are barred from working with children. Decisions and reasons are recorded confidentially.

Single Central Record

Gavin Copland keeps a Single Central Record of every person who works or volunteers with learners. It records each check in the table above, the date it was done and who carried it out. The Directors check the record every term, and it is available to commissioners, the local authority and inspectors on request.

6. Induction and probation

On their first day, every new member of staff or volunteer completes a safeguarding induction covering our Safeguarding policy, staff code of conduct, Behaviour policy, Online Safety policy, Whistleblowing policy, how to raise a concern, and the role of the Designated Safeguarding Lead. They read Part 1 of Keeping Children Safe in Education and sign to confirm they have done so.

New staff complete a 3-month probation period, with recorded reviews at weeks 4, 8 and 12 covering safeguarding practice, conduct and competence. Probation is only signed off when the person has shown they work safely. It may be extended, or the appointment ended, if concerns are not resolved.

7. Ongoing suitability

Staff must tell us straight away about any caution, conviction, investigation or other circumstance that could affect their suitability to work with children. We check each person's status on the DBS Update Service every year and record the result on the Single Central Record. Any allegation against a member of staff is handled under our Safeguarding policy and referred to the Darlington LADO.

Where we remove someone from working with children because they have harmed, or might harm, a child, we will make a referral to the DBS as the law requires.

8. Volunteers and students

Volunteers and students on placement go through the same recruitment process, proportionate to their role. Anyone in regulated activity has an enhanced DBS check with barred list check. Volunteers not yet fully checked are supervised at all times and never left alone with learners.

9. Contractors, visitors and partner organisations

Contractors and visitors who have not been checked by us are supervised at all times and never left alone with learners. Before we use another organisation to work with our learners, such as a guest workshop provider or an activity venue, we get written confirmation that its staff have had appropriate checks, including an enhanced DBS check where they will be in regulated activity. When they arrive, we check each person's photo ID against that confirmation, and we monitor the session.

10. Records and data protection

Recruitment records are kept securely and in line with UK GDPR, our Data Protection policy and our Records Retention policy. We do not keep copies of DBS certificates. We record the certificate number, date of issue, the outcome and who checked it. Records of unsuccessful candidates are kept for 6 months and then destroyed securely.

11. Review

This policy is reviewed every year, and sooner when Keeping Children Safe in Education or other statutory guidance changes.

Related policies

Read this policy alongside our Safeguarding, Whistleblowing, Behaviour, Data Protection and Records Retention policies, and our staff code of conduct.

Approval and signatures

This policy has been approved by the Board of Directors of Hustle Hive CIC.

Name	Position	Signature	Date
Gavin Copland	Director and DSL		
Kieron Davis	Director		
Carey Viala	Director		
Sarah Smith	Director		